# SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

**FINANCIAL RECOVERY STRATEGIES AMONG FOOD SERVICE ENTERPRISES IN AGUSAN DEL NORTE**

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Business Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION
MAJOR IN FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

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# SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

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College Of Business Management And Accountancy

**CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL**

This thesis entitled **"TAX LITERACY AND COMPLIANCE OF SELECTED STARTUPS IN AGUSAN DEL NORTE: BASIS FOR TAX EDUCATION PROGRAM"** presented and submitted by **RIEZA JOY SARFOCIAL, PATRICK CZAR C. ACENAS, LIEKA MAE A. GEPIGA, MICHELLO VHANN R. IGLESIAS, PITCH PEARL D. PAJARILLO, and SHELA MARIE T. PATOC** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Financial Management**, is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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**ABSTRACT**

**TITLE:** FINANCIAL RECOVERY STRATEGIES AMONG FOOD SERVICE ENTERPRISES IN AGUSAN DEL NORTE
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**I. OBJECTIVES**

This study aims to assess the financial recovery strategies employ by food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte, which will offer valuable insights to help improve support for rural food enterprises and guide policies that promote sustainable local economic recovery.

**II. METHODOLOGY**

The study employs a descriptive quantitative research design to determine the socio-demographic profile, the level of impact of the COVID-19, and the financial recovery strategies on food service enterprises in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen Agusan del Norte. Data will be gathered through an adapted and modified survey questionnaire with permission from Renato M. Samonte Jr., Ali G. Mamaclay, and Manuel P. Castillo (2022). Data will be collected from purposely selected business owners and managers through face-to-face survey.

**KEYWORDS**: Cost Management, Financial Recovery Strategies, Financial Support, Food Service Enterprises

**DEDICATION**

## ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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# CHAPTER 1
# THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

## 1.1 Background of the Study

The food service sector is vital to the economy because it generates employment, supports local suppliers, and provides communities with essential services. The food service sector plays a vital role in the Philippine economy by creating jobs, supporting local suppliers, and providing essential services. When COVID-19 struck in 2020, lockdowns and health protocols severely disrupted food service operations. Many enterprises experienced sharp declines in sales, unstable cash flow, and difficulty sustaining daily expenses, including employee salaries. As restrictions eased, businesses adopted various financial recovery strategies through changing menus, shifting to online selling, and seeking government assistance. While some establishments managed to regain stability, others continue to struggle with long-term financial challenges. Understanding these strategies is crucial for assessing how food service enterprises can recover and remain viable in the "new normal." In Agusan del Norte, small and medium food service businesses are still navigating post-pandemic financial and operational adjustments. However, there is limited research on their recovery efforts, especially in rural municipalities like Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen. Understanding these differences is important for designing targeted recovery interventions that truly address local needs. This study aims to identify the financial recovery strategies used by these enterprises and examine how these strategies relate to the extent of COVID-19's impact. Findings will help determine the most effective approaches to business recovery and contribute to strengthening local economic resilience.

Due to the pandemic, many food service businesses implemented digital solutions. Many companies now use mobile apps for digital buying, payment, and contactless delivery as a recovery strategy (Kutnjak, 2021). As the pandemic poses serious economic threats,

businesses are also developing innovative ways to market their products (Wang et al., 2020). Digital ordering, delivery, and payment systems that do not require a card reader allow businesses to continue operating even during lockdowns. To retain users, (Puriwat & Tripopsakul, 2021) argue that the digital world needs to change immediately and adopt to recover the financial losses. Renegotiating supplier contracts, altering the menu, and managing staffing are all efficient methods of cost reduction, according to (Zainol et al., 2023). (Baum, 2020) also say that the most important things for the long-term recovery of the hospitality business are new ideas and investing in employees. Furthermore, the current literature focuses on large restaurant chains and does not consider small to medium-sized businesses (SMEs) in rural areas (Lontchi et al., 2023). Nevertheless, most research worldwide uses a cross-sectional design, examining only the short-term consequences of the pandemic and overlooking long-term consequences. The gaps highlight the need for local, SME-focused research to assess the effectiveness of financial recovery planning across different environments.

The same study in the Philippines, MSMEs, including food service enterprises, have a poor track record of fluctuating cash flow and, on average, excessive debt, influenced by the lack of formal financial support (De Vera, 2024). In addition, the dual aspects differ between urban and rural businesses. Most food enterprises lack digital access services and access to financial inclusion, hindering sales and business growth in rural regions (Mia et al., 2024). Introducing online payment systems, such as GCash, advertising on social networks, and online delivery services will stabilize the revenue streams of small food businesses. Angeles (2022) says that a sign of recovery among MSMEs using digital tools is financial management. In addition, study Samonte et al., (2022) mention that food service establishments that adopted e-commerce and social media advertising experienced greater patron involvement and partially recovered demand. According to the study by (Moraga et al., 2023), other strategies

adopted by food service businesses include financial controls and pursuing government support to protect against economic shocks. According to (Alvarez, 2020), for any food service to be successful, no other task of marketing management is more important than identifying the marketing strategies, evaluating them, and selecting those the business would pursue to be unique and frequented by customers.

There are patterns of adaptation according to local studies. According (Flaminiano et al., 2021), financial literacy, credit access, and digital access readiness can significantly transform the small businesses in Mindanao. (Malinao, 2022) emphasize that resilience in the face of disruptions is achieved through sound financial discipline and effective resource management. According to (Lestari et al., 2022), flexible financial strategies can help businesses address fluctuations caused by the crisis. According to (Okeke et al., 2024), factors such as financial planning and a proactive orientation toward long-term growth and flexibility are essential. Nevertheless, the majority of available Literature on urban areas, such as Davao City, Cebu City, and Metro Manila, offers little information on less urbanized areas, such as Agusan del Norte, where seafood-based and community-oriented businesses prevail (Varela et al., 2022). Therefore, it still lacks local studies examining the correlation between internal business variables such as ownership type, years of operation, and number of employees and the success of financial recovery in local food businesses, given the COVID-19 impact in the new normal. This became a pressing issue for food service businesses as they sought to return to normal working conditions after the pandemic.

This study assesses the financial recovery strategies of food service businesses in Agusan del Norte as they work to restore normal operations following the business. The study focuses on how internal business attributes such as the type of food service industry, type of business ownership, years of operation, and number of employees influence the financial recovery strategies of food service enterprises. It also considers the level of pandemic impact in areas

such as finances and cash flow, raw material shortages, labor shortages, demand reductions, and policy disturbances to determine how these challenges shape recovery actions. The research further examines key financial recovery strategies, including cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support. Understanding these aspects provides insight into how companies can maintain operations and financial stability, as well as restore performance during economic challenges. This research aims to gather information to capture the local business situation and offer evidence-based suggestions on how small and medium food enterprises can enhance resilience, become more stable, and become more sustainable in the long run.

The research will significantly enhance the sustainability and resilience of local food service businesses in the post-COVID-19 era. Local communities will also benefit from a thriving food industry, as it will help create jobs and ensure a steady food supply. Policymakers and local government units may use the results to develop programs and financial support systems that strengthen MSMEs resilience. Banks may develop inclusive credit and lending services to support small businesses, while universities can apply the findings to improve the teaching of business and finance. This study also helps researchers understand its relevance to the business field, particularly in examining how internal resources shape MSME resilience. It can serve as a basis for future research on financial recovery strategies and resource management among food service enterprises. Additionally, this study is valuable to the CBM Department because it will provide real-world insights that strengthen instructions in finance, accounting and management courses. Overall, the study contributes to local economic development by providing evidence-based that supports sustainable business operations. Hence, the paper aims to identify and examine financial recovery interventions that will enhance sales growth, economic stability, and the business sustainability of the food service industry.

## 1.2 Review of Related Literature

Different food service businesses use various methods to recover costs, depending on their setup and business type. Formal restaurants often use online platforms to keep sales going, while small community-based restaurants depend on loyal customers and support from the community to keep cash flow going. During the COVID-19 pandemic, these differences became even more evident as lockdowns, mobility restrictions, and the sudden drop in consumer demand forced many food service establishments to halt or limit operations. The pandemic created challenges such as supply chain disruptions, dine-in restrictions, and increased operational costs, making financial recovery more difficult. Samonte et al. (2022) say that when looking at the recovery plans of food service businesses, it is essential to look at both internal business factors like types of food service industry, types of ownership, years of operation, and number of employees, as well as operational problems like a lack of finances and cash flow, raw materials shortage, labor shortage, demand reduction, and policy disturbance. These factors show how businesses address issues and remain stable after the pandemic. Samonte et al. (2022) explain that food service enterprises use several strategic actions to survive and recover from financial disruptions. Their study highlights four major areas: managing operational expenses, securing alternative income activities, using digital platforms for marketing and customer engagement, and seeking assistance from government and private institutions. These actions directly relate to cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support, making them appropriate indicators for assessing financial recovery strategies among food service enterprises.

### Types of Food Service Industry

Food service companies are crucial to businesses' success, growth, and long-term sustainability, especially in developing economies. These businesses include full-service restaurants, fast-food chains, catering services, cafeterias, and specialty food stores (Deligero,

2025), because customers have different expectations, menus, and service delivery, each type of business needs to manage and run things in its own way. Research indicates that other segments of the food service industry face challenges with sales growth, financial viability, and operational sustainability. Bhattacharya et al. (2021) note that full-service restaurants often struggle with cash flow due to their high fixed costs. On the other hand, quick-service restaurants can adapt more quickly to business changes. Studies from the U.S. and Europe also show that online ordering and delivery systems help fast-casual and quick-service restaurants recover more rapidly (Dhillon et al., 2025). Niche food shops, such as health and organic stores, have become more stable and longer-lasting (Jones & Comfort, 2020).

In the Philippines, the food service business is just as varied. Fast-food chains like Jollibee and Mang Inasal remain popular because they offer affordable, readily available food (Jonson & Rempillo, 2023). Many small food businesses, such as cafés and neighborhood restaurants, struggle to earn enough daily to stay open and grow. Bayaua (2025) highlight the importance of new ideas for maintaining funds in good condition, which many catering services now offer meal packages. Twaño (2024) also says that different types of businesses need different approaches to getting back on their feet, as not all food businesses recover at the same rate.

Overall, studies show that the type of food service business affects its financial performance and recovery. However, few studies have examined small food businesses in rural or semi-urban areas. This study fills that gap by examining how local food service businesses in Agusan del Norte manage their cash flow, debt, financial stability, and long-term viability as they rebuild after a disaster.

**Types of Business Ownership**

There are various types of business ownership in the food service industry, including sole proprietorships, partnerships, corporations, and cooperatives. Budgeting and proper

decision-making are critical in keeping operations afloat. The structure of ownership determines the availability of funds, debt management, and the flexibility in running the business, which, in turn, impacts the company's financial stability in bad times (Anoos et al., 2020). There are also growth opportunities and a competitive advantage, which depend on the type of ownership. Formal management systems and greater financial resources (corporations and franchises) are more likely to achieve higher sales and recover without delay.

Sole proprietors in Malaysia have a harder time managing their debt and cash flow than partnerships and corporations do because they have fewer options for bank credit and financing (Azmi & Indriyani, 2023). Partnerships and corporations in the United States could more easily access government support during the pandemic (Granja et al., 2020). Fairlie (2020) states that sole proprietorships are easy to manage but do not offer long-term financial security. In the Philippines, most businesses and small shops are run by one person. This means their cash flow can be unstable, and they may not even be able to get credit (Jones & Comfort, 2020). Partnerships and corporations are more prevalent in richer cities with greater knowledge of how to run their affairs (Cabili et al., 2025). Cooperatives also help people access shared resources and increase their bargaining power (Raquiza, 2021).

However, most rural owners cannot formalize their businesses, making them more susceptible to financial problems and injunctions. Despite evidence of the positive roles of corporate and Partnership types in supporting sales growth and sustainability, few studies examine how ownership style influences small food businesses in rural areas of the Philippines. This study fills that gap by examining how different types of ownership structures among food service businesses in Agusan del Norte affect their recovery plans and business performance.

**Years of Operation**

When examining the experience, stability, and flexibility of a specific business in the market, the first thing to consider is the number of years the business has been in operation. Nevertheless, long-established businesses might possess a stronger network, loyal clients, and greater business knowledge, which can help them manage cash flow more effectively and become financially stable (Bachtiar et al., 2023). When a crisis occurs, new companies may behave in ways that are non-powerful or short-lived, though they can also develop new ideas and change. Studies on developed and developing economies have revealed that sustainable businesses can survive and fail during a financial crisis, depending on the presence of established structures and after-sales service support. The time food service companies had in business was beneficial for their survival during the COVID-19 outbreak, compared with newly established companies that began operations in China ((Li et al., 2021). Likewise, in the U.K., businesses that have been operating longer are more likely to receive financial support, which has revived sales momentum (Brown & Lee, 2020).

However, according to international literature, older firms sometimes prove less innovative than younger firms (Liu et al., 2023). Experience, stability, and flexibility are the most significant factors quantified by years of market business operations. Conversely, a business with a long history, an established network, stable customers, and experience is more likely to be successful (Bachtiar et al., 2023). On the other hand, new businesses cannot afford to cope effectively with a crisis and, if they fail, can be innovative and flexible, too. Food service companies with a long history of operations in China were better positioned to continue operations during the COVID-19 outbreak than newer companies (Zhang et al., 2025). The longer a business operates, the greater its chances of receiving financial relief, which, in turn, will revive sales momentum in the U.K. (Brown & Lee, 2020). Thus, the Literature suggests that older businesses might not be as creative as the newer ones (Liu et al., 2023). Old

restaurants and food chains have survived in the Philippines throughout the financial crisis by learning to transform their businesses over the years (Moraga et al., 2023).

Nevertheless, other concerns are more likely among small businesses under 3 years old, which may encounter unexpected issues with profits and debt from the beginning (Castillo et al., 2025). Other concepts among local researchers are that long-term operations are reliable with financing and that loans and credit become more likely to be obtained (Guliman, 2020). Flexible companies, though more recent, tend not to be affluent or have the right contacts to sustain themselves through a crisis. However, there is a lack of literature on the impact of the duration on small, rural food destinations in Agusan del Norte. The following research question will address whether a long operational history helps recover financial conditions or how nascent enterprises will better adapt to local conditions.

**Number of Employees**

Most of the food service industry consists of restaurants owned by corporations that have operated for years. A business's number of employees describes its size, labor capacity, and structure. According to (Samonte et al., 2022), most companies have a small number of regular employees and a larger number of casual and contractual employees due to workplace restructuring and transformation brought by the COVID-19 pandemic. The workforce is crucial to business survival, cash generation, and sales growth, particularly in small food-service enterprises, where labor expenses constitute a significant share of operating costs (Moraga et al., 2023). The management systems of larger businesses are usually more formal, whereas the ones of smaller companies may be informal. High-risk industries, including food service, manufacturing, and accommodation, are significantly impacted by employment imbalances (low income or job loss) (Peralta et al., 2022). The more employees a business has, the greater the chances are that the company will recover faster and operate better in times of crisis.

In Korea, food service employers have large teams introducing digital platforms, such as online ordering and delivery, to help maintain sales (Park et al., 2021). A larger workforce enhances productivity and cash flow by redistributing tasks during disruption (European Commission, 2020). Increased staff increases fixed costs and makes the company more vulnerable to declining revenues. In most food service enterprises in the Philippines, the number of employees is fewer than 10, making it challenging to serve well and meet demand (National Tax Research Center, 2023). Mid-sized restaurants and catering services employ more workers and are more stable because they can delegate tasks and maintain service quality (Andaya et al., 2021).

Nevertheless, labor expenses may burden small and medium enterprises with fewer customers (Castillo et al., 2025). According to the literature, workforce size influences financial recovery and performance. However, little research has examined the impact of employee numbers on small food service businesses in provincial locations, such as Agusan del Norte, where labor demand, customer capacity, and market conditions differ from those in urban areas. This paper closes this gap by analyzing the connection between workforce size and financial recovery in the local food service industry.

**Finances and Cash Flow**

When the economy declines, MSMEs in the food service sector in provinces like Agusan del Norte rely on financial recovery to stay in business. Peralta et al. (2022) say that measures that improve liquidity, such as keeping necessary stocks and making new agreements with suppliers, help to close the gap between cash inflows and short-term liabilities and stabilize the finances. The study by Cabili et al. (2025) also says that restaurants in Iligan City are changing their regular pricing and distribution models to adaptive ones to improve cash flow and keep customers coming back. Another crucial factor in financial resilience is digital payment. According to Diaz (2025), electronic transactions enable faster

cash cycles and greater access to broader markets when mobility restrictions are in place. Additionally, according to Glindro et al. (2024) digital payments in the Philippines will reduce physical cash use and enhance financial transparency. Raquiza (2021) further notes that organized budgeting and financial forecasting help make cash flow more predictable and support informed financial decisions.

However, not every plan works out well. Pagaddut (2021) says that Agusan del Norte is in a temporary cash-flow crisis because it spent too much on digital infrastructure and engaged in aggressive marketing. Some MSMEs do not consider how much they can repay and take out new loans that do not align with their cash inflows and outflows. These financial problems make recovery measures less effective, especially when making payroll and loan payments (Anoos et al., 2020). Poor financial literacy also contributes to the problem. According to (Paulite & Espiritu, 2025), most microenterprises cannot assess the effects of long-term profitability because they depend on short-term survival strategies such as discounts or supplier credit. Cook (2025) argues that frequent price changes and a lack of financial information decrease consumer confidence. Pinca et al. (2023) also conclude that sound financial planning and capacity-building programs enable sustainable cash flow and long-term recovery.

**Raw Materials Shortage**

The increase in the cost of operations strains food service MSMEs of Agusan del Norte, forcing them to adopt a financial recovery strategy that maintains liquidity and stable cash flow. To address the challenge of raw material shortages, minimize reliance on national supply chains, and smooth their cash flows, MSMEs have resorted to diversification of suppliers, frequent purchasing cycles and direct sourcing of local farms and cooperatives (De Guzman & Quezon, 2024). The Department of Agriculture program, the Kadiwa, helps strengthen the union between local producers and the MSME, lowering the price of purchases and raising the

level of profitability (Zhang et al., 2025). Many companies have computerized their instruments, inventory management, and forecasting software to monitor expenditure and circumstances, as well as aligning what is coming in with the operational needs. Financial planning is capable of increasing predictability through resilient food systems that would contribute to long-term sustainability (Varela et al., 2022).

However, poor planning and mismanagement of finances lead to cash flow problems among some of the MSMEs. Small businesses waste half of their funds to buy large volumes or shift suppliers without considering the demand in the market (Nasereldin et al., 2021). Poor inventory control and oversupply are wasteful and decrease the liquidity (Ivanov & Dolgui, 2020). The absence of storage and transportation in Agusan del Norte remains a question that keeps increasing the costs and reducing the profitability (Queiroz et al., 2022). Additionally, majority of the owners of MSMEs lack financial literacy and do informal businesses, increasing vulnerability to raw materials shortage (Paulite & Espiritu, 2025).

Therefore, integrating supply chain planning and local sourcing with financial management is critical in developing resilience. The lack of these coordinated strategies can lead to failure of recovery efforts to fund financial issues arising due to raw material as well, extending operational disruptions and cashflow issues (Enthoven & Van den Broeck, 2021).

**Labor Shortage**

In business, employees are the backbone of its success. Duran (2024) explains that online ordering, mobile payment, and automated inventory tracking can prevent labor deficit in food service enterprises, as manual work is minimized, and small teams can effectively handle the customer demand. Agusan del Norte food service MSMEs can mitigate labor shortages by implementing multi-skilled work, flexible substitutes, and digital tools. According to Peralta et al. (2022), one reason for the presence of various staff members in specific job duties, such as a cashier who prepares food and keeps operations going, is limited staff. Such

a solution will achieve high productivity while minimizing the number of workers required during peak season. Labor gaps by part-time employees and students do not increase the fixed wage expenses (Adviento et al., 2022). The change to digital management systems also puts pressure on labor. Also, the adoption of technology enhances productivity in the regions, where low-qualified labor supply is observed, and allows MSMEs to remain in business despite labor shortages (Mia et al., 2024).

Nevertheless, Baum (2020) observe that some recovery plans exclude labor issues. Burnout and high turnover are the results of multi-skilling and lean staffing. (Niere et al., 2023) finds that uncompensated excessive workloads cause employees to leave, contributing to the labor shortage and cost-cutting labor solutions can lead to long-term unsustainability. There are also new problems arising from digitalization. (Bachinger et al., 2020) and (Flaminiano et al., 2021) conclude that although digital tools increase efficiency, they favor older or less technologically proficient employees. In Agusan del Norte, many food service employees in rural areas face digital access barriers that hinder inclusivity (Duran, 2024). Financial recovery plans are poorly developed and can only worsen the labor crisis rather than address it.

**Demand Reduction**

Some financial bandages worked, but further problems arose due to weaker demand. The shift to technologies such as online ordering and mobile payments enabled food service establishments to engage customers despite physical limitations during the height of the pandemic. The business would continue to demand from clients during the pandemic, particularly younger, more active online clientele. Alhassan et al. (2025) state that this points to the influence of flexible menu options in demand stimulation via bundling promotions. These responded to the pandemic-inflected ways consumers adapted their use and spending.

Moreover, Cueto et al. (2022) uses a structural equation model to investigate the influence of recovery strategy activities adopted by MSMEs in the food service sector that demand restoration following digitalization and customer-driven innovation. The ones with online ordering, social media marketing, and a flexibly modified menu were much better able to adjust to unstable demand. A study Samonte et al., (2022) found that food service establishments that adopted e-commerce and social media advertising experienced greater patron involvement and partially recovered demand. The business remains relevant and affordable to clients because it is beautiful to frequent visitors to online platforms. It could compensate for the impact of mobility restrictions and evolving consumption patterns (Laroya, 2021). The varying levels of effectiveness of digital approaches in Agusan del Norte indicated an unequal footing in terms of digital infrastructure and access to technology. Especially in rural councils, numerous micro and small food service businesses lacked reliable internet access, digital devices, or the skills to use online services. New digital technologies, however, were not so benign for small entities, which had great difficulty competing for the opportunities they afforded (Duran, 2024). For companies that did not shift online, foot traffic had dried up, and demand had further diminished because regular promotional offers were not attracting new customers.

The supplementary cost pressure in demand recovery strategies amplifies the adverse effects of the demand cutback. These substantial upfront investments in new health protocols, store layout refits, and more efficient delivery logistics are out of the reach of most MSMEs. According Gunawan et al. (2023), food service enterprises in Caraga lack income and liquidity, preventing them from changing operations to recover. The mandated compliance and safety operational changes were too severe, creating a vicious cycle that led to fewer resources, shorter operating hours, limited service and product menu offerings (limited scope

of work), and a reduced workforce. Such moves directly reduced consumer demand and further supported its contraction (Isa et al., 2025).

**Policy Disturbance**

The Policy disturbance makes MSMEs in the food service industry in Agusan del Norte more innovative and strengthens their support networks. The pandemic's shocks have prompted the government to focus on developing technological and financial programs to help businesses pursue stronger recovery plans. The COVID-19 crisis also prompts different government agencies and some companies to work together more quickly, helping to restore some customer demand (Labiaga & Campos, 2024). The changes to the policy are always different, and sometimes they do not happen all at once. These make it hard for them to understand when making financial plans. Changes in health guidelines, operating permits, and lockdown orders that occur regularly make it harder for businesses to get back on their feet (Flaminiano et al., 2021). These strange events force food service businesses to repeatedly change their layouts, staff, and supply chains, often without a set schedule or financial support.

In Agusan del Norte, where institutions like municipalities have improved their ability to do their jobs, inconsistent policy implementation hinders the recovery process and depresses demand (Talabis et al., 2021). Changes in funding policy make it hard to know if funds and government subsidies will be available. Raquiza (2021) notes that MSMEs in the Philippines and in Caraga have had difficulty accessing financial programs. It is unclear who is eligible to apply. Food service businesses do not have the proper paperwork or computer skills to request help. The differences in priorities between national and local agencies make it hard to get the resources where they are needed. The burden makes small businesses hesitant to sign up for formal recovery programs, so many rely on other means to earn money or cut back, making it harder for them to get back on their feet and stay stable (Oikawa et al., 2025).

**Cost Management**

Cost management in the context of financial recovery strategies for food service businesses underscores the importance of keeping operating costs low and using comprehensive financial plans to keep the business going during crises such as the COVID-19 pandemic (Samonte et al., 2022). Cost management in food service businesses requires several approaches. To cut operating costs, companies often restructure their workforces to reduce labor costs and ensure that essential employees continue to have a payroll. To keep food costs as low as possible, choose suppliers carefully, keep track of supplies, and monitor how much it costs to consume. Budgeting and variance analysis, setting standards for cost items (food, labor, overhead), and regularly comparing actuals against budgets enable management to respond quickly and effectively. Automation and digital solutions will increase costs' visibility and control by integrating technological tools into procurement, inventory, and forecasting (Bagcat & Sy, 2023).

Dubenskaia (2025) on the other hand, says that cost management techniques in public catering establishments have several harmful effects. Small and medium-sized enterprises will likely face high implementation costs and technical barriers due to the high upfront investment required for new technologies (such as automation and online platforms). They cannot easily integrate these technologies into their operations without technical expertise. These can cause problems for the company and reduce the potential benefits of cost management interventions. Without proper training, businesses may lose money adopting new technologies without equipping their employees with the necessary training or following standard processes. This is because mistakes and wasted time can happen. Potential resource losses from organizational flaws, unclear shift schedules, inadequate employee training, and failure to establish standard procedures lead to inefficiency, overtime, mistakes, and resource losses, all of which hurt efforts to manage costs.

Another downside of cost management for food service businesses trying to get back on track financially is that strict cost-control measures can hurt staff morale and trust, making them unwilling to follow set procedures. Workers who think internal controls are too strict may lose motivation or confidence in the company. This can lead to less job satisfaction, less work getting done, and even higher turnover rates. This harms operational productivity and makes it harder to implement financial recovery plans (Gumbo & Sukdeo, 2024).

Recent studies also show that operational problems can be caused by inadequately trained staff, those not held accountable, or those unwilling to use new technologies. These factors lead to inconsistent application of cost control mechanisms, common differences in portion sizes, and inefficient adaptation to changes in ingredient prices. As a result, cost management strategies could not achieve their desired effects despite being well aware of their impact on the food service enterprise's financial and sustainability (Melchor et al., 2025).

**Income Sources**

Income sources in food service businesses' financial recovery plans show how important it is to have a variety of income streams to be stable during and after economic downturns like the COVID-19 pandemic. One important finding is that many restaurants could make significant earnings when traditional food services were limited or shut down by focusing on other ways to make money, like takeout, delivery, online sales, and selling goods in stores. Studies show that restaurants that invested in digital platforms for shopping and takeout services rebounded faster and kept their cash flow steady during business interruptions (Yost et al., 2021)

Businesses were able to reach new groups of people through social media marketing and advertising, which led to more possible income sources and less loss from traditional sales methods (Samonte et al., 2022). As consumer needs changed, partnerships and local sourcing became very important. These companies made packages or new product lines that met

customers' needs by working with nearby farms, suppliers, and other small businesses (Bagcat & Sy, 2023); this helped them stay open and make more money. Even though having more than one source of income is usually seen as a way to remain financially stable, it may not be suitable for food service companies. Costs increase, and operations become more difficult when more ways are added to make money, like meal kits, delivery, catering, online services, etc. This can make things more difficult and require more staff, technology, and logistics handling. According to new studies, small businesses that lack the right tools can find it hard to manage multiple digital platforms, making their operations less efficient and their service quality less reliable.

Additionally, Kahveci (2025) indicates that introducing new income strengthens competition; hence, small and medium enterprises should apply coordinated plans to ensure stable performance and all customers remain satisfied. This is especially true in food delivery and online markets, where well-known names already have a lot of market share. Due to there being too many options, it can be hard to stand out, leading to lower-than-expected results. Small restaurants may struggle to keep their identity when their business spread across too many platforms. Customers get confused, and the restaurant loses focus on its primary business when it offers too many channels or goods. This can confuse customers about the brand and make them less faithful, especially if the food and service quality or authenticity go down because of too much expansion (Chung et al., 2025).

**Online Marketing**

Online marketing is a key part of food service businesses' plans to get back on track financially, mainly because it helps them reach customers and run more cost-effective ads. Studies have shown that digital platforms and social media marketing help businesses stay strong, keep customers, and return to normal faster during emergencies like the COVID-19 pandemic. During the pandemic, restaurants that quickly started using digital marketing and

online delivery services could keep making money and adjust to how customers reacted differently. Orbe & Valenzuela (2023) confirm that digital platforms like GrabFood, FoodPanda, and Angkas Food significantly improved food service SMEs' operational efficiency and financial performance during economic uncertainty.

According to Iwarue & Asanga (2025), online outlets help food-service businesses keep in touch with their current customers, keep their brand visible, and get new customers, which speeds up their financial recovery. Using social media for promotion has been linked to more customers and repeat business, which is vital for food businesses to return to making money. Real-time conversations with customers via Instagram and Facebook lead to creating customer trust and encouraging them to order again, which helps quick-service restaurants earn more. Li et al. (2021) additionally point out that with the help of digital advertising and discounts provided via e-commerce stores; small restaurants could recover lost revenues and manage their financial flows more efficiently.

However, even though social media sites make it easier to be seen, using them to promote unhealthy foods can hurt customer trust and make it harder for businesses to grow long-term. Fretes et al. (2025) study shows that online marketing can harm food service businesses. These include unhealthier food ads, problems running the company, and possibly losing customer trust. Kids and teens exposed to digital ads for bad foods and drinks are more likely to eat and drink those things. Online ads and material created by influencers made people eat more snacks, which may be bad for the health of some consumer groups. Social media ads can change the digital food world and encourage people to eat unhealthy foods, leading to bad eating habits and the health risks that come with them.

Furthermore, Muangmee et al. (2021) said that the fast growth of online food delivery services creates major operational problems, such as inconsistent food quality, delivery delays, and changing levels of customer happiness. This can damage customer confidence and

render digital food service less helpful unless it addresses the systemic issues. The excessive use of technological solutions without ensuring the most basic service standards (e.g., food is hot and full) may irritate the customers and leave them with negative reviews, which will further damage loyalty and encourage repeat business. There is a limited number of large companies dominating the entire market that restrict innovation and diversity in that specific field. Likewise, Mitra et al. (2023) notes that the safety of the food, exposing low-income clients to financial vulnerability, and the lack of trust that people have in the online purchasing systems can be solved through online marketing and digitalization. To most people, the internet sites are not the best for recovery due to increased prices, additional charges, and a lack of proper handling of perishable products.

**Financial Support**

Financial assistants are crucial for food service businesses to recover after the economy slows down. MSMEs are able to stay financially stable and deal with the enormous problems caused by the COVID-19 pandemic with the help of programs like targeted grants, low-interest loans, and tax relief (Sabar, 2023). Bagcat & Sy (2023) note that food businesses in Davao City operated by other companies relied on formal financial assistance offered by institutions and informal assistance provided by personal networks to compensate for a shortage of financing. This enabled them to spend minimally and sustain their businesses through the crisis. These results show how important it is for food service businesses to have easy access and good communication about financial assistance programs. The financial help that food service businesses got from the government during the COVID-19 pandemic, like grants, tax breaks, and easy access to low-interest loans, did help.

Nevertheless, many small businesses fail because they do not know about or cannot access help programs. Not enough resources are shared evenly, and some people cannot get proper credit or help. Some food business owners became too dependent on outside financial

aid and did not work to improve their management systems, which led to more debt and fewer benefits for long-term financial planning or new ideas. Lestari et al. (2022) said that taking out informal loans from family and friends can make it harder to make business decisions and hurt personal relationships, which could cause mental stress. Still, they were sometimes hard to use because of paperwork or delays, which made them less useful during essential times. This was especially true for food service businesses that did not have good records or digital access. Based on these results, support programs must do more than help with access and funds. They also need to make it easier for businesses to implement their plans and encourage them to use sustainable, self-sufficient ways to make money.

**1.3 Theoretical Framework**

The study will be anchored on Jay Barney (1991), Resource-Based View (RBV), which states that an organization's success and ability to bounce back from setbacks rest on its resources and skills. The theory says that companies can stay ahead of the competition if they have and use resources that are valuable, rare, hard to copy, and well-organized. Barney (1991) has listed four attributes of resources that can give rise to a firm's competitive advantage: value, rarity, imperfect imitability, and lack of substitutability. The resources such as financial capital, human capital, operational processes, and managerial skills, help businesses adapt and improve, especially during crises like the COVID-19 pandemic.

The independent variables in this study are the type of food service industry, type of business ownership, years of operation, and the number of employees. These variables show the internal resources and structural capacities of each company. These traits affect how well businesses can handle problems and use strategies to recover financially (Samonte et al., 2022). Corporations with formal structures and longer operation histories may have stronger financial systems and easier access to cash. On the other hand, smaller, less formal businesses may depend on adaptability and support from the community to stay open.

The first dependent factors that show how much COVID-19 has affected things are finances and cash flow, raw materials shortage, labor shortage, and demand reduction and policy disturbance. These outside forces put the companies to the test of their ability to keep running and stay stable during the pandemic. According to RBV, these effects are like outside shocks that show the company's real resource strengths and flaws. The ability of small food enterprises to withstand and recover from pandemic-related disruptions was primarily shaped by their internal resource base and structural configuration (Moraga et al., 2023)

The financial recovery strategies show how businesses use their own resources to get back on track financially. These include cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support. Cost management shows how well a business spends its limited funds; income sources show how creatively it finds new ways to make money; online marketing shows how well it can use and adapt technology; and access to financial support shows how formalized the business is and how creditworthy it is. Together, these signs clarify how internal strengths translate into practical actions for dealing with a crisis.

Therefore, the RBV framework is a good starting point for this study because it shows how differences in internal resources affect both how bad the pandemic is and how well food service businesses in Agusan del Norte can recover. Businesses that are better at managing their money, having well-organized structures, hiring skilled workers, and being able to adapt to new technology should have less downtime and recover faster (Samonte et al., 2022). Thus, (Lestari et al., 2024) mention that using RBW theory helps examine how businesses compete using their own resources and external forces.

This theory explains the correlation between the independent and dependent factors. It backs up the study's goal of finding out how resource-based strengths affect the ability of local food businesses to recover financially after a pandemic.

**1.4 Schematic Diagram**

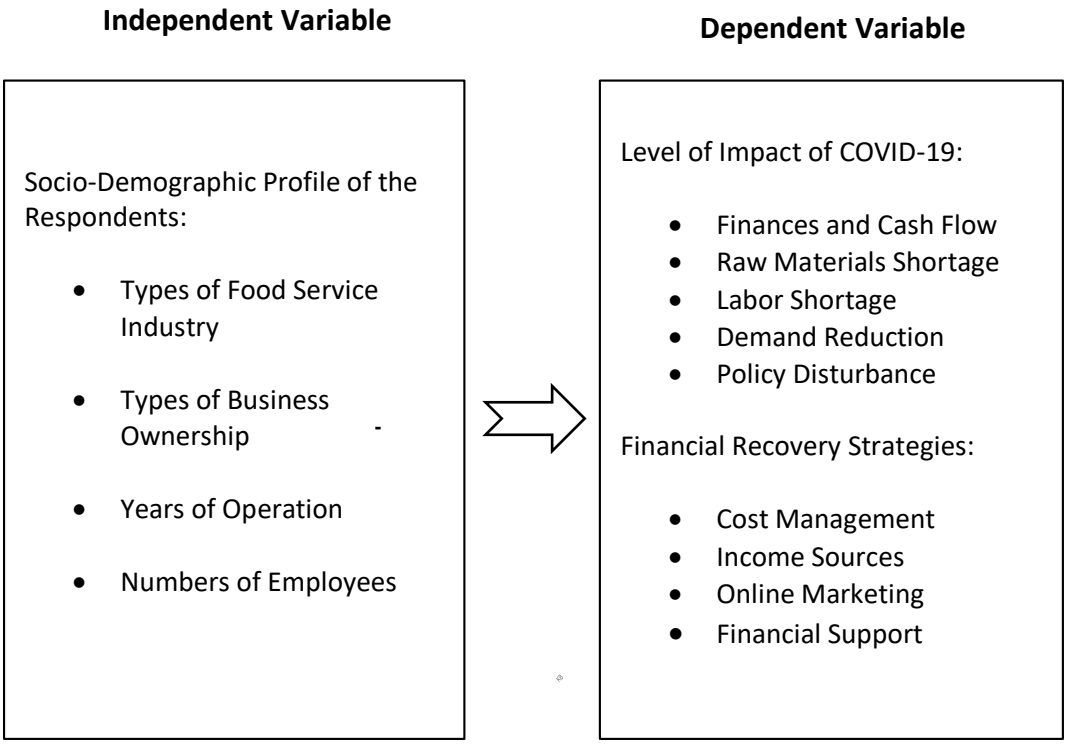



***Figure 1.*** *Shows the interplay between independent and dependent variables of the study.*

**1.5 Statement of the Problem**

This study aims to assess the financial recovery strategies among food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte. The study includes registered food service businesses such as restaurants, cafés, eateries, catering services, and food stalls that operated before, during, and after the COVID-19 pandemic and remain active.

Specifically, it will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the socio-demographic profile of selected food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte in terms of;

    1.1 Types of Food Service Industry

    1.2 Types of Business Ownership

    1.3 Years of Operation; and

    1.4 Number of Employees

2. To what extent are your business's operations being impacted by COVID-19 in terms of;

    2.1. Finances of Cash Flow

    2.2 Raw Materials Shortage

    2.3 Labor Shortage

    2.4 Demand Reduction; and

    2.5 Policy Disturbance

3. What financial recovery strategies are implemented by the food service enterprises in response to the challenges brought by the pandemic in terms of:

    3.1 Cost Management

    3.2 Income Sources

    3.3 Online Marketing; and

    3.4 Financial Support

4. Is there any significant relationship between the socio-demographic profile and the financial recovery strategies among food service enterprises?

**Hypothesis**

**Null Hypothesis**

There is no significant relationship between the socio-demographic profile and the recovery strategies among food service.

**1.6 Scope and Limitation**

This study will assess the financial recovery strategies of food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte, specifically in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen. The study includes registered food service businesses such as restaurant, food service in hotels, fast food chains, cafes, kiosks and counters, catering food services, cafeterias, eateries that operated before, during, and after the COVID-19 pandemic and remain active. The respondents are managers and business owners of food service businesses that were in operation prior to the COVID-19 pandemic, remain operational, and are registered with the Business Permit Licenses Office (BPLO). A total of sixty-nine (69) food service enterprises will be selected through purposive sampling to ensure that only businesses relevant to the research objectives are included.

**1.7 Definition of Terms**

The terms are operationally defined based on their use in this study.

**Business Ownership.** Refers to the legal form enterprises of the organization of food service: Sole proprietorship, Partnership, and Corporation.

**Cost Management.** Refers to the process of overseeing and controlling business expenses in order to make sure that expenses are not in excess of the budgets.

**Demand Reduction.** Refers to the decrease in consumer demand and sales transactions experienced by food service enterprises during and after the pandemic**.**

**Finances and Cash Flow.** Refers to the financial condition and liquidity of food service enterprises post-pandemic. They generate income and maintain sufficient cash inflow to sustain operations.

**Financial Recovery Strategies.** refer to how food service businesses will handle debt, reduce costs, market themselves online, and stabilize income after the pandemic.

**Food Service Enterprises.** Refers to the locally based businesses (restaurants, cafés, kiosks and counters, hotel food service, and eateries) that provided food services that existed and were still in operation before and after the pandemic.

**Financial Support.** Refers to the financial assistance or subsidies businesses receive through cash, grants or loans.

**Income Sources.** Refers to the different ways in which businesses earn money.

**Labor Shortage.** Refers to the reduction of personnel, turnover of employees, and fewer recruitments in food service enterprises.

**Number of Employees.** Refers to the enterprises' employees and analyzes the business's size and the workforce's sustainability.

**Online Marketing.** Refers to the use of social media or online platforms to promote the businesses and reach customers.

**Policy Disturbance**. Refers to the disruptions in business operations cause by the changes in government policies, regulatons, or health guidelines during and after pandemic.

**Raw Materials Shortage.** Refers to the insufficiency or unavailability of materials and ingredients needed for production.

**Years of Operation.** Refers to the length of time the food service business has been in active operation and is associated with experience, organizational maturity, and the capacity to withstand.

# CHAPTER 2
# METHODOLOGY

## 2.1 Research Design

A descriptive quantitative research design will be used in this study. A descriptive research design is a quantitative research design that describes the features of a population, situation, or phenomenon systematically and factually. It does not address the question of why or how of the research problem. Still, it addresses the question of what and obtains the data on the subject using surveys and questionnaires, thus providing a clear picture of the current situation. The study adopts this design since it will enable the researchers to objectively explain the socio-demographic profile, the level of impact of COVID-19, and the financial recovery strategies used by food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte. This study aims to measure and analyze the existing conditions without manipulation, providing a clear basis for recommending and conducting further research.

## 2.2 Research Locale

The research will be conducted in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen municipalities in the province of Agusan del Norte, in the Caraga Region of Mindanao, Philippines. These municipalities are experiencing an increase in the number of food service businesses, cafés, kiosks, food outlets, eateries, and restaurants that operated before and after the COVID-19 pandemic.

Written history of the town of Buenavista began in the year 1877 when a group of nomadic Manobo on the borders of Agusan discovered that the place was just the right location to act as an interim fishing reserve and a meeting place. Soon the town of Tortosa was established by Christian pioneers Innocentes Paler and Marcelo Dalaguida who were later joined by Luis Gupana and a few Manobo and the village was later known as Kihaw-an and then finally changed the name to Buenavista, which translates to Good View, Until 1907

settlers continued to pour in and by the 1920s Buenavista was linked to Butuan by road, had electricity, was declared a regular barrio of Butuan with its own law-making body and finally became a municipality through the efforts of Assemblyman Apolonio D. Curato, Governor Jose R. Rosales, Commissioner Teofisto Guingona Sr., and Secretary of the Interior, Elpidio Quirino.

The recorded history of Nasipit can be traced as early as 1880, when it was declared a pueblo by the Spanish colonizers. According to townsfolk, its name may be attributed to an incident where a native, just after being bitten by a crab, was asked the name of the place by an immigrant. Misunderstanding the question, the native answered “na-si-pit”, meaning bitten by a crab. Since then, the town became known as Nasipit. Nasipit was officially separated from the municipality of Butuan on August 1, 1929. It became a municipality by virtue of Executive Order No. 181 issued by Acting Governor General Eugene Gilmore of the U.S. Army. Former Governor Teofisto Guingona Sr. initiated a proposal to change the name to Aurora, but due to strong opposition from townsfolk, the name Nasipit was retained.

In the early 1900s, the family of Fulgencio Loque and Demetria Mamba of Jagna, Bohol had settled in the present-day Kabayawa village (currently called Carmen) and moved into the village peacefully, trade with the native Manobo and Higaonon tribes and a barter system strictly conducted their lives until Fulgencio passed away in 1903. The village was changed to Carmen in praise of a miracle image of the Virgin of Mount Carmen, which is thought to have helped to subdue the outlaws in the area, as proposed by Rev. Saturnino Urios. The date of the official establishment of Carmen as a municipality was July 1, 1949, when several barrios were annexed to Nasipit under the Republic Act No. 380, sponsored by Congressman Marcos M. Calo.

The choice of these three municipalities, with different economic roles and business environments, gives the study a more representative and better interpretation of the financial recovery strategies valued by food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte.

**2.3 Research Respondents**

The research will be conducted among the selected food service enterprises in the Province of Agusan del Norte, specifically in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, in the Caraga Region, Mindanao, Philippines. The study includes registered food service businesses such as restaurant, food service in hotels, fast food chains, cafes, kiosks and counters, catering food services, cafeterias, eateries that operated before, during, and after the COVID-19 pandemic and remain active. The study targets respondents who are the business owners and managers of all registered food service enterprises that operate in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. The study excludes enterprises outside the three municipalities and those that began operations only after the pandemic, as they cannot provide information on financial recovery from COVID-19. A total of sixty-nine (69) food service enterprises will be selected through purposive sampling to ensure that only businesses relevant to the research objectives are included. This study will employ purposive sampling to select a sample of sixty-nine (69) food service enterprises as a result of the sample size needed to cover the research objectives, and only those enterprises that were relevant to the research objectives were included.

**Table 1.** *Total Population of Respondents*

| AREA OF RESPONDENTS | POPULATION | SAMPLE FREQUENCY | SAMPLE PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|---|
| BUENAVISTA | 54 | 45 | 65.1% |
| NASIPIT | 25 | 21 | 30.1% |
| CARMEN | 4 | 3 | 4.8% |
| **TOTAL** | **83** | **69** | **100%** |

SAMPLE SIZE: 69

**2.4 Research Instrument**

The primary tool for gathering information for the study will be an organized and modified survey questionnaire. The study by Renato M. Samonte Jr., Ali G. Mamaclay, and Manuel P. Castillo (2022), called "Business Strategies Employed by Food Service Industries to Survive the Impact of COVID-19," will be used as a model for the instrument, along with some changes. Part I and II of the evaluation will be taken directly from their work.

Part I will collect information about the respondent's socio-demographic, such as type food service industry, type of ownership, years of business operation, and number of employees.

Part II will analyze how COVID-19 affected business operations by examining finances and cash flow, the lack of raw materials and workers, demand reduction, and policy disturbance.

Part III will assess the financial recovery strategies (cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support), the practical ways businesses utilize resources to recover.

This study aims to create the items under each indicator, which will then be compared to related Literature to see how these strategies help businesses recover and stay stable. Respondents to the form will be graded on a five-point Likert scale. Here is how each statement will be graded: High Extent (4), Moderate Extent (3), Low Extent (2), and No Extent (1). These numbers will show how much each business is affected by COVID-19 and how they plan to recover.

Content validation of the instrument will be conducted by consulting the research adviser to assess its accuracy, relevance, and alignment with the research aims. The original authors have pilot-tested the instrument, and reliability was determined in their earlier study.

## 2.5 Research Ethical Standards

The study will be conducted in accordance with strict adherence to institutional ethical standards and national regulations to ensure participants' rights are protected. Their data will not be at risk, and the entire research process will be conducted in accordance with ethical standards. The study will be conducted in accordance with moral principles at each step of the data investigation process (data collection, data reporting, etc.). This will help preserve the integrity and credibility of the research.

**A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights**

All intellectual property rights will be acknowledged, and proper attention will be given to the authors by referencing and recognizing the source of all the data, materials, and tools used in the research. Future reproduction of no copyrighted, patented, or proprietary materials will be made in advance unless the rightful owners authorize it. This encompasses the survey tool created by Samonte, Mamaclay, and Castillo (2022), for which permission has been granted and received. These steps would ensure that the researchers guarantee the ethical and legal use of all intellectual property.

**B. Informed Consent**

Before the study is carried out, respondents will be clearly informed of the objectives, scope, procedures, potential benefits, and duration of their participation. The informed consent forms will be carried out and clarified informally so that the participants understand the research and their part in it. Only participants who voluntarily provide informed consent will be included in the study. This process will help ensure that respondents are not manipulated and that they participate by informed choice.

**C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality**

The confidentiality of all the information collected in the course of the study will be given paramount importance. The identities of the respondents will be confidential, and none

of the identifying information will be included in the report and presentation. Data obtained will be stored in files that are password-protected and will be available to the research team. All completed survey questionnaires will be treated with strict confidentiality and will only be accessed by the researchers and the research adviser. After data collection, the physical forms will be stored securely for five (5) years to allow verification and meet research archiving requirements. After this period, the forms will be shredded, and all digital files will be permanently deleted to ensure the full protection of participants' information. This will ensure the participants' privacy is not compromised and that their trust in the research process is retained.

**D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw**

The involvement in this study will be entirely voluntary. The respondents will also be informed that they may choose not to participate in the study or drop out at any time, without any consequences or penalties. This value supports participants' autonomy and ensures their free will guides their involvement.

**E. Minimization of Harm and Risk**

The study design is not risky to the subjects. No survey questions will involve sensitive or personal financial records and will be associated only with non-sensitive business operations, no physical, psychological, or reputational harm. If any participant feels uncomfortable when collecting data, they will be given a chance to avoid the questions or pull out. The research team will approach the expectation of professionalism at all times to have a respectful and safe experience.

**F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge**

The research will have significant implications for the research community regarding financial recovery strategies and business performance among food service enterprises in Agusan del Norte. The research findings should be helpful to participating businesses,

policymakers, support institutions, and future researchers, as they will be able to pinpoint effective measures to undertake in the aftermath of the pandemic to lead to recovery. This agrees with the principle of beneficence, which aims to maximize the advantages of research to society.

**G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection**

Purposive sampling will select respondents based on clear inclusion criteria, such as food service enterprises operating before and after the COVID-19 pandemic and remaining in operation during the study period. This ensures that the qualified respondents have an equal chance to participate. The sample will reflect the extensive diversity of Buenavista, Carmen, and Nasipit food service companies.

**H. Data Integrity and Accuracy**

The study's data will be coded, checked, and analyzed to ensure reliability and accuracy. The study team will use strict data-checking procedures to prevent errors, manipulation, or data falsification. Inconsistencies will be fixed immediately if found. Regarding honesty and correctness, these steps back up the study results. Corrective steps will be taken right away if any problems arise. If any discrepancies are detected, corrective actions will be taken immediately. These measures support the research results in terms of integrity and accuracy.

**I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting**

The researchers will ensure that they remain honest and transparent during the research. All the findings, methodologies, and limitations shall be reported truthfully and accurately. Under no circumstances will plagiarism, fabrication of data, or falsification be accepted. All sources will be credited to ensure academic integrity.

**J. Use of Patent or Copyrighted Materials**

Third-party materials will be used with appropriate permission and complete recognition by the authors or creators of the original works. This incorporates the fact that survey instruments, reference materials, and other tools are applied in compliance with the copyright laws. In this way, the research complies with the legal and ethical standards.

**K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials**

This research includes no animal study or invasive human research. Only consenting adults will be included, and it is limited to the surveys that respondents are given and cannot include any other study processes. There are no experimental treatments, medical procedures, or interventions involved.

**L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies**

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools will be employed solely for grammar checking, formatting, and reference management (e.g., Mendeley). There will be no idea of AI to create, fabricate, or manipulate data. This guarantees that any research output remains authentic and human-led without having an impact on professional presentation guidelines.

**M. Ethical Approval and Institutional Approval**

An Ethical Clearance Application Form will be presented to the SMCC Ethics Review Committee, which shall be appropriately reviewed and approved during the commencement of data collection. The Business Permit and Licensing Office (BPLO), the Mayor's Office, and the Treasury Office of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen will be requested to obtain official permission. The owners and managers of the identified food service enterprises shall also receive letters of request formally inviting them to participate and cooperate in the study.

**2.6 Data Gathering Procedure**

This study will be conducted in selected food service enterprises. The researchers will observe the following processes during data collection for this study.

**Letter of Approval.** Formal letters will be issued to the Business Permit and Licensing offices (BPLO) of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen of Agusan del Norte. Also, letters will be sent to the mayors requesting permission to obtain the list of food service businesses in their areas/jurisdictions. These letters will have been operated openly from the Office.

**Distribution of Questionnaires.** The researchers will administer the survey questionnaires to the respondents in person after they give their consent. The questionnaire contains only two parts (Part 1, which is the Socio-Demographic Profile, and Part 2, which is the Impact of the Pandemic) on the instrument of Renato M. Samonte Jr., Ali G. Mamaclay, and Manuel P. Castillo (2022). There will be enough time for the respondents to complete the questionnaires. After the respondents have answered the survey, the researchers will get the questionnaires that they have completed.

**Data Tallying and Organization.** All the collected data will be counterchecked for completeness and accuracy, then tallied, entered, and systematized and entered into the system. The obtained data will be counted, coded, and summarized using frequency counts and percentages. Similar to the original study, Part 1 will contain the socio-demographic profile of the enterprises in tabular format. In contrast, Part 2 will include the impact of Covid -19 indicators that will be tallied based on the number of respondents who experienced each item on the list. Part III will assess the financial recovery strategies.

The research will use these descriptive statistics tools to interpret and display the data easily, aligning with the study's quantitative descriptive design. Part 2: Impact of the Pandemic on Business Operations. The following section will identify the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on businesses in the (A) Finances and Cash Flow, (B) Raw Materials Shortage, (C)

Labor Shortage, (D) Demand Reduction, and (E) Policy Disturbance. Part III, will assess the financial recovery strategies such as cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support. Applicable statements that respondents will indicate will be based on the effect on their business operations.

**2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure**

The survey questionnaire is the primary data collection method for the study, with the sampled food service enterprises within the municipalities of Buenavista, Carmen, and Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. The instrument collects the socio-demographic characteristics (type of food service industry, company ownership, years of operation, number of employees), level of pandemic impact (finances and cash flow, raw materials shortage, labor shortage, demand reduction, and policy disturbance), and financial recovery strategies which will be measured based on cost management, income sources, online marketing, and financial support.

The socio-demographic profile of the respondents, along with the level of effect of COVID-19 and the extent of adoption of financial recovery strategies, will also be profiled using the counts of frequencies, percentages, mean, and standard deviation. Each indicator will be identified using the weighted mean to get the average response of the general level of impact and strategy application among food service enterprises.

To examine the relationship between business profiles and their financial recovery strategies, the study will apply Pearson's r correlation. The standard deviation will measure how consistent the responses are among the participants. These tools are among those that have been similarly utilized to profile the food service industry locally.

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| ORGANIZATION | POSITIONS HELD |
|---|---|
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**Membership/Affiliations**

| ORGANIZATION | POSITIONS HELD |
|---|---|
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|---|---|
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| ORGANIZATION | POSITIONS HELD |
|---|---|
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**Membership/Affiliations**

| ORGANIZATION | POSITIONS HELD |
|---|---|
| Junior Financial Executives (JFINEX) - SMCC Chapter | Member |
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**Membership/Affiliations**

| ORGANIZATION | POSITIONS HELD |
|---|---|
| Junior Financial Executives (JFINEX) - SMCC Chapter | Member |
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# APPENDICES